

Norway

Ratio: 8:11 **Adopted:** July 17, 1821 **Usage:** National and Civil

The red, white, and blue colors were influenced by the French *Tricolore*—a symbol of liberty—and by the flags of the UK and USA



Off-centered white cross on a red field is taken from the Danish flag

Europe



Ruled by Denmark from 1397, **Norway** passed to Sweden in 1814. It gained independence in 1905, when its union with Sweden was dissolved.

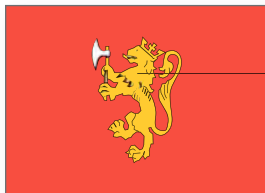
Until 1814, the Norwegian flag bore the Danish red and white cross. The current flag was born in 1821, during the period when Norway was united with Sweden. The flag combines two influences; its red and white coloring was taken from the Danish flag, and a blue cross was added overall. These three colors were chosen in honor of the French

Tricolore, a symbol of revolution and liberty. They were also the colors of the flags of the United States of America and the United Kingdom, two other countries that were not ruled by an absolute monarch.

The Royal Standard consists of a banner of the Royal Arms, dating back to the Middle Ages. It depicts a lion rampant on a red field.

THE ROYAL STANDARD

The standard dates back to the Middle Ages



A tall, slender lion bearing the ax of St. Olav